and brightest feather in Talwar's cap, it was by no means the only one. There was no field in the bank's working where he did not leave his impress; in his case it was not a few feathers—it was a veritable plumage.

Raj Kumar Talwar, popularly known as R.K. Talwar, was born on June 3, 1922, in Jhelum, Punjab, now in Pakistan. He completed his Bachelor's degree from D.J. Sind College, (now known as D.J. Science College in Karachi). He did his postgraduation in Mathematics from Government College, Lahore, topping his class with record marks. The thing to do at the time was to appear for the ICS, but Talwar who had a strong bias against Western culture chose not to appear for it. Also, the training for the civil service would require him to learn horse-riding, something which Talwar decided was not for him. Instead, he decided to try his luck at the Imperial Bank of India. He was called for an interview and since Lahore fell under the jurisdiction of the Bengal Circle, he had to go to Calcutta for the interview.

He reached Calcutta a day before the interview and decided to do a preliminary survey of the premises. When he reached the office of the Secretary and Treasurer, a peon questioned him about the purpose of his visit. When Talwar told him that he was a candidate for a job at the bank, he was told that he stood very little chance since family connections weighed heavily in sending letters of appointment.

Notwithstanding the discouragement, Talwar appeared for the interview the following day. His academic record was such that the bank found it impossible to ignore his outstanding credentials. He joined the bank as a Probationary Officer in 1943 and was confirmed in the job in 1946. His first posting was in Lahore which within a few years was involved in the tumult of Partition. When the rioting showed no signs of abating, Talwar sent his wife and infant son to India in a Pakistani military truck arranged by Muslim friends. Talwar, along with his co-religionists at the bank, were forced to take shelter at the bank premises since there was no guaranteeing their safety if they stepped out into the city. Talwar recalled later how the Muslim guards at the bank brought food for them and took care of their needs. When Talwar applied for leave to look for his wife and son, he was told off by his British superiors at the bank: 'You people asked for Independence and you have got it. Why do you want 'leave' now?'[1]